1. Welcome to Northwind Labs

Northwind Labs is a software company founded in 2016 and headquartered in Lisbon, Portugal. We build logistics planning tools for mid-sized retailers. This handbook explains how we work together and what you can expect from us.

Our standard working week is 40 hours. Core hours are 10:00 to 16:00 local time: during this window every team member should be reachable for meetings. Outside the core hours you can arrange your day freely, as long as you agree your schedule with your team lead.

The company currently employs about 120 people in Portugal, Spain and Poland. New employees receive a laptop and an access badge on their first day, and are paired with an onboarding buddy for the first three months.

2. Leave and Time Off

Every full-time employee receives 25 days of paid annual leave per calendar year. After three years of service you receive one additional day for each further three years of service, up to a maximum of 30 days. Unused leave can be carried over to the next year, but at most 5 days, and carried-over days expire on March 31.

Sick leave: you may take up to 10 paid sick days per year without a doctor's note. From the fourth consecutive day of absence a medical certificate is required.

Parental leave: the primary caregiver receives 18 weeks of fully paid leave. The secondary caregiver receives 6 weeks of fully paid leave. Parental leave can be taken in one block or split into two blocks within the first year after the birth or adoption.

3. Remote Work

Employees may work remotely up to 3 days per week. A fully remote arrangement requires written approval from a Vice President and is reviewed every 12 months.

Home office equipment: every employee receives a one-time home office stipend of EUR 400 for a desk, chair or monitor. In addition, the company reimburses internet costs of up to EUR 40 per month on presentation of the invoice.

Working from abroad is allowed for a maximum of 20 days per calendar year because of tax and social security rules. You must notify the HR department at least 14 days before you travel. Working from abroad without notification is not covered by company insurance.

4. Travel and Expenses

Submit expense reports within 30 days of the expense. Reports submitted later may be rejected. Approved expenses are reimbursed with the next payroll run.

Business travel: meals are reimbursed up to EUR 60 per day. Flights are booked in economy class for journeys shorter than 6 hours and in premium economy for journeys of 6 hours or longer. Hotels may cost up to EUR 180 per night. Any single purchase above EUR 500 needs written pre-approval from your manager.

Learning budget: each employee has a personal learning budget of EUR 1,200 per year for courses, books and conferences. The budget does not roll over to the next year.

5. Information Security

Passwords must be at least 14 characters long, and multi-factor authentication is mandatory for all company systems. All laptops must use full-disk encryption; IT enables it before handing over the device.

If a laptop or phone is lost or stolen, report it to IT within 2 hours. Security incidents and suspicious emails are reported to security@northwind.example. The use of USB storage devices is prohibited on company laptops.

Every employee completes the mandatory security awareness training once a year, in October. Employees who miss the training lose access to production systems until it is completed.

6. Performance, Pay and Notice

Performance reviews take place twice a year, in May and in November. Salary reviews take place once a year, in January.

Employees can earn an annual bonus of up to 10% of their annual salary, depending on the achievement of company targets.

The probation period is 6 months. The notice period for resignation is 1 month during the first two years of employment and 2 months afterwards.

Questions about this handbook can be sent to the HR Director, Marta Silva, at hr@northwind.example.